

Bwana awabariki (May God grant you a blessing)

Text: Swahili; Kenyan traditional; tr. anonymous

Music: Kenyan traditional

BWANA AWABARIKI irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 4/4 time, using a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (Bb). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some phrases spanning across bar lines. Chords are indicated by letters above the staff: F, Dm, Bb, C, F/C, C7, and F. The lyrics are written in two lines below the staff, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across notes or bar lines. The first line of the score covers the first two measures, and the second line covers the next three measures, ending with a double bar line.

F Dm Bb C

Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki, Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki,
May God grant you a bless - ing, may God grant you a bless - ing,

F Dm Bb F/C C7 F

Bwa - na a - wa - ba - ri - ki, mi - le - le
may God grant you a bless - ing, ev - er - more.